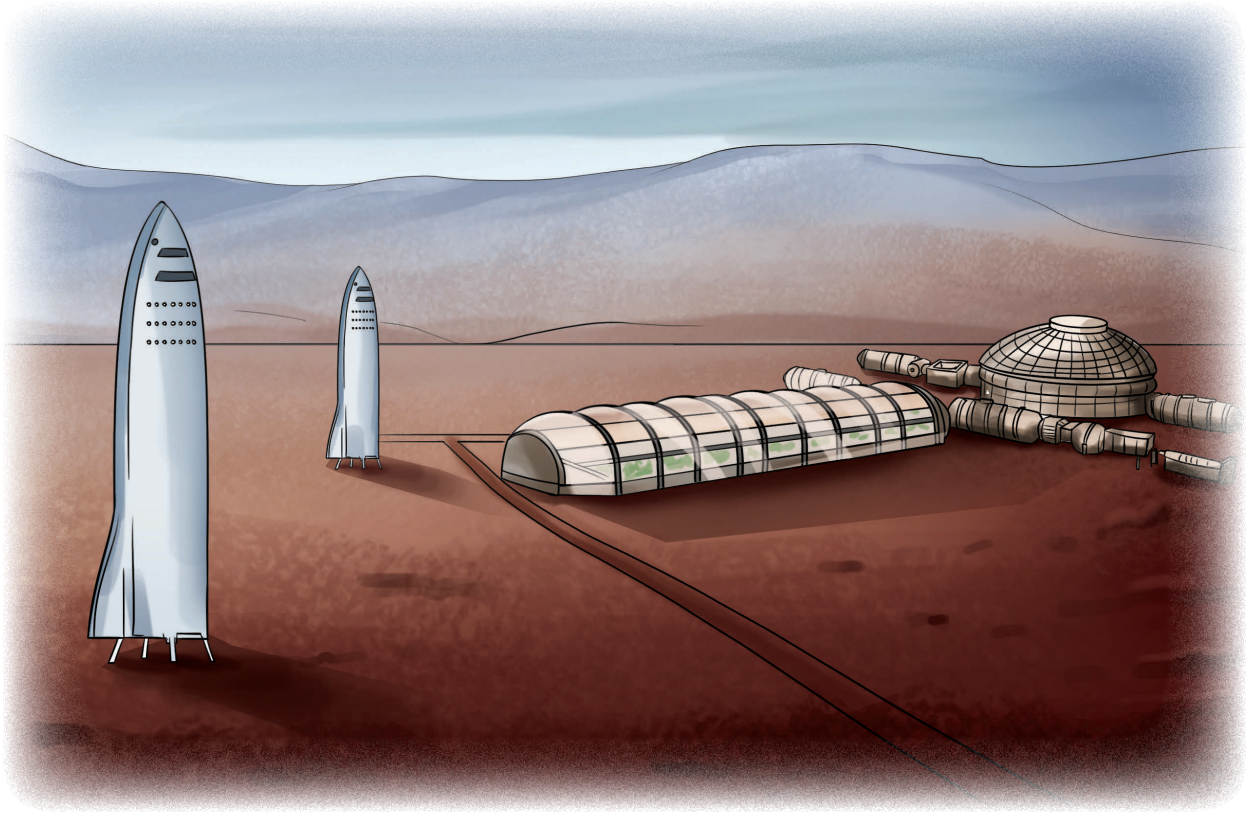


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Earth, the Desolated Home



It was the year 2068, humans had destroyed the Earth, and started colonising the red planet Mars. India established three colonies; Arivumathi's family lived in one such colony. On her birthday, her grandfather travelled more than 1500 km to meet her. When he reached, he saw her sleeping in her **capsule**.

He said, "Wake up, Arivu." Arivumathi was surprised, "Grandpa! When did you come? I was thinking that you won't be coming for my birthday." He sighed, "Don't you know about the dust storm of Mars? Sometimes, it even lasts for a month. But this time it did not. So I am on time. It still took me three **sols** to reach here. Now come on, let's not waste time. We will go to harvest the vegetation **hab** for vegetables."